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Afghanistan secured its first-ever series win against a team ranked in the ICC's top five, defeating South Africa 2-1 in a thrilling ODI contest. Under the leadership of Hashmatullah Shahidi, Afghanistan dominated the opening match by bowling South Africa out for just 106, comfortably winning with six wickets in hand. In the second game, Afghanistan posted an imposing 311, which South Africa failed to chase, resulting in a massive 177-run victory for Afghanistan. However, South Africa, led by Aiden Markram, managed to avoid a clean sweep with a consolation win in the final game, triumphing by seven wickets.



EMMANUEL YOGINI

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Australia Women clinched the series by winning two of the three T20Is against New Zealand. In the first match, Phoebe Litchfield's unbeaten half-century steered Australia to a successful chase of 144. Although New Zealand levelled the series with Amelia Kerr's four-wicket haul, which restricted Australia to 142 in the second game, Ashleigh Gardner (**above**) made a triumphant return after a concussion scare before the opener, claiming three wickets to secure Australia's series win in the final match.



REUTERS

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Ricky Ponting has been appointed as the head coach of IPL team Punjab Kings (PBKS) on a four-year contract. The former Australian captain previously served as the head coach of Delhi Capitals for seven seasons, stepping down after the 2024 edition. Under his leadership, the Capitals reached the playoffs in 2019, 2020, and 2021 and made their first-ever final appearance in 2020.



AFP

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The three-match T20I series between Australia and England ended in a draw after the third match was abandoned due to rain. The Aussies took the lead after securing a 28-run victory in the opener. However, England made a comeback in the second game, beating Australia by three wickets. The final game did not see a ball bowled. In the five-match ODI series, Australia leads 2-1, having won the first two games by seven wickets and 68 runs, respectively.